INDIAN INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY VADODARA

TREASURE OF CODE

Crack the Code. Solve the Riddle. Find the Treasure.

AN INTERACTIVE PUZZLE-DRIVEN CODING CHALLENGE

DATE	31 October 2026
TIME	12:00 PM – 2:00 PM
VENUE	IIIT Vadodara, GEC
ROOM	9102 A/B Lab
ORGANIZER	cout << "Masters";
INSTITUTE	Indian Institute of Information Technology Vadodara

I. ABOUT THE EVENT

Treasure of Code is a puzzle-driven programming event that combines competitive coding, logical reasoning, and the excitement of a treasure hunt. Participants progress through five interconnected coding challenges, each accompanied by a riddle that must be solved in order to advance to the next stage.

Every stage presents a programming problem and an accompanying riddle. The result or required code obtained by solving the challenge serves as the key to unlock the next stage. Participants must think critically, write effective solutions, interpret clues, and debug their programs as they move closer to the final treasure.

With every solved challenge revealing the path ahead, the event offers a continuous and engaging experience in which programming skills and problem-solving abilities go hand in hand.

II. OBJECTIVES

The event aims to:

- Encourage students to practise programming and algorithmic thinking in a fun, competitive environment.
- Develop logical reasoning and analytical skills through riddles, clues, and interconnected challenges.
- Promote persistence, debugging, and systematic problem-solving.
- Encourage active participation in technical activities and foster a strong coding culture.
- Make programming more engaging by combining computational thinking with a treasure-hunt experience.

III. HOW IT WORKS

The event begins with a screening quiz (Round 1), after which the qualified participants take part in *Treasure of Code* (Round 2), which follows a sequential, five-stage challenge format. The output of every stage becomes the input of the next one. Follow the link for demo : link

STAGE 1	**Start with the Given Input.** The input for Stage 1 is provided on the coding platform. Participants use it on the Treasure Map to unlock the Stage 1 riddle, then use the same input to solve the coding problem and obtain the output.
STAGE 2	**Output Becomes Input.** The output of Stage 1 is the input of Stage 2. Participants use it on the Treasure Map to unlock the Stage 2 riddle, and use it in the Stage 2 coding problem to obtain the next output.
STAGE 3	**Continue the Hunt.** The output of Stage 2 is the input of Stage 3. Participants use it on the Treasure Map to unlock the riddle, then solve the problem to obtain the output.
STAGE 4	**Keep Going.** The output of Stage 3 is the input of Stage 4. The same process repeats, requiring accuracy, logic, and persistence.
STAGE 5	**Reach the Treasure.** The output of Stage 4 is the input of Stage 5. Using it on the Treasure Map and in the final coding problem yields the final key that leads to the treasure.

Input » Treasure Map » Riddle » Code » Output » Next Input » Repeat » Find the Treasure!

IV. WHAT WE PROVIDE

The organizers will provide the following to every participant at the venue:

- **Treasure Map:** The map on which the input of each stage is used to unlock that stage's riddle. The link for the map will be provided on the coding platform.

- **Quiz (Round 1):** The first round will be conducted on mobile phones; the link for the quiz will be provided by the organizers.
- **Coordinator and volunteer support:** Assistance with queries about rules, and technical help with the website systems.
- **Live timekeeping and scoreboard:** Official timing of every stage, so that rankings are fair and transparent.
- **Coding platform:** The link for the coding platform will be given on the day of the event to the listed participants.
- **Accessories:** Charging points will be provided, together with internet access. Mobile phones may not be carried in Round 2.

What Participants Must Bring

- Laptops and accessories (charger, mouse, etc.).
- Pens, blank white paper (nothing should be written on it), and water bottles (if required).

V. CODING PLATFORM

Round 2 is conducted entirely on the systems brought by the participants. An online judge and internet-based platform is used.

ENVIRONMENT	Participants' own systems in Room 9102 A/B Lab, in offline mode
LANGUAGES ALLOWED	C, C++, Java, Python, etc.
TOOLS	One type of browser to be used only (Chrome recommended)
LIBRARIES	Standard language libraries only; offline documentation is available
EXECUTION	Programs are compiled and run locally on the lab machine using the stage input; the output of the program is the key for the stage
VERIFICATION	The participant submits the key to the treasure map, who verifies it before issuing the next stage.
RESTRICTIONS	No internet, no mobile phones or smartwatches, no external storage, and no pre-written code

VI. ROUNDS AND GUIDELINES

The event is conducted in two rounds. Round 1 is a short screening quiz that filters the participants; Round 2 is the *Treasure of Code* hunt itself, comprising all five stages.

Round 1 | The Screening Quiz

Duration: 10 minutes (12:05 PM – 12:15 PM)

Objective: Screen participants on programming fundamentals, logical reasoning, and quick thinking, and select the participants who proceed to the main hunt.

Format:

- A timed quiz covering programming concepts, output prediction, aptitude, and logical puzzles.
- The quiz is attempted at the participants' allotted seats and is completed within the 10-minute limit.
- Answers are evaluated immediately after the round. The quiz contains 20 questions, with 30 seconds allotted to each question.

Guidelines:

- Only the participants who qualify through the quiz are admitted to Round 2.
- Participants are shortlisted by their score; ties are resolved by the time of submission.
- The list of qualified participants is announced before Round 2 begins.

Round 2 | Treasure of Code (Stages 1–5)

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes (12:25 PM – 1:55 PM)

Objective: Solve the five connected coding challenges and riddles, and reach the treasure.

Format:

- Only the participants qualified through Round 1 participate.
- Each stage presents a programming problem with an accompanying riddle; the resulting output or code serves as the key to the next stage.
- Stages must be attempted strictly in sequence; a stage cannot be skipped.
- The key obtained at Stage 5 leads to the location of the treasure.

Guidelines:

- Each key is verified by the Treasure Map before moving to the next stage.
- The first participant to submit the correct final key, together with the correct submission of the code for that riddle, is declared the winner.
- Hints may be offered by the organizers at a time penalty, at their discretion.
- If time expires, participants are ranked by the highest stage cleared, followed by the time taken.

VII. INDICATIVE SCHEDULE

TIME	ACTIVITY
12:00 PM – 12:05 PM	Registration, seating, and briefing
12:05 PM – 12:15 PM	Round 1: Screening Quiz (10 minutes)
12:15 PM – 12:25 PM	Evaluation and announcement of qualified participants
12:25 PM – 1:55 PM	Round 2: Treasure of Code (1 hour 30 minutes)
1:55 PM – 2:00 PM	Closing with greetings

VIII. RULES AND REGULATIONS

General

1. Participation is open to all students of the institute and is strictly individual.
2. Every participant must carry a valid institute ID card and report by 12:00 PM sharp.
3. The decision of the organizers and coordinators is final and binding.
4. The event runs in the allotted lab only; participants must not leave the room without permission.

Round 1: Quiz

1. The quiz is strictly time-bound (10 minutes); answers submitted after the time limit are not considered.
2. Participants must attempt the quiz individually without discussion; the use of mobile phones, notes, or the internet is not permitted.
3. Only the participants announced as qualified are allowed to participate in Round 2.

Round 2: Coding and Technical

1. In Round 2, solutions may be written in C, C++, Java, or Python on the lab systems provided.
2. Mobile phones, smartwatches, and any form of external storage are strictly prohibited.
3. Pre-written code, notes, and printed material may not be used.
4. In Round 2, each stage's key must be obtained by actually solving the problem; sharing or guessing keys is not allowed. Doing so will allow the participant to obtain only 10% of the points.
5. Programs must be executed on the coding platform, and the coordinator may ask a participant to demonstrate the solution.

Scoring and Evaluation

1. Participants are ranked by the number of stages completed, and then by the total time taken.
2. Total time is measured from the start of Round 2 until the key of the last cleared stage is verified by the Treasure Map, plus all time penalties (incorrect submissions and hints), and is recorded by the coordinator.
3. Each incorrect key submission adds a time penalty.

4. In the event of a tie in the number of stages completed, the participant with the lower total time (including penalties) is ranked higher. If the total time is still equal, the participant who submitted the key of the last cleared stage earlier, as recorded by the coordinator, is ranked higher.

Code of Conduct and Disqualification

1. Participants must maintain discipline and decorum and treat fellow participants, volunteers, and the lab property with respect.
2. Communication with other participants is not permitted. Collaboration, copying, or any unfair means will result in immediate disqualification.
3. Tampering with the system settings, other participants' work, or the event's clues will lead to disqualification.
4. Disputes must be raised with the coordinator immediately and politely, within the same stage.

IX. WHAT MAKES IT SPECIAL

- **Five Connected Challenges:** Each solution brings participants closer to the final goal.
- **Coding Meets Mystery:** Programming problems are paired with riddles and clues.
- **Think Beyond the Code:** Success requires both correct programming and logical interpretation.
- **An Interactive Experience:** Every completed stage unlocks a new part of the journey.

Think Smart. Code Sharp. Hunt the Treasure.

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